

Friday, 3 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 26° 15°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 25° 14°	MANCHESTER Overcast 21° 14°	GLASGOW Drizzle 17° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The Prime Minister has issued a formal apology for the forced adoption of thousands of babies in the UK between 1949 and 1976.

Keir Starmer described the practice, which saw babies taken from their mothers, as 'a stain on our history'. This follows years of campaigning from those affected, calling for recognition and a formal apology.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

A convicted people smuggler, once called 'the godfather' of French migrant camps, has been found living in the UK and seeking asylum.

The man was convicted in France but a BBC investigation located him working in a Leicestershire village. This revelation raises serious questions about border security and asylum processes.

IMMIGRATION · UK
- 3

The leader of a notorious grooming gang, Shabir Ahmed, has been released from prison, sparking widespread concern.

Ahmed, known as 'Daddy' to his victims, was jailed for 22 years in 2012 for his role in horrific crimes. His release will be a difficult moment for his victims and their families.

CRIME · UK
- 4

Get ready for more sunshine! A third UK heatwave is looking increasingly likely, with temperatures forecast to hit 30 degrees Celsius.

Forecasters predict temperatures will climb throughout the weekend, potentially leading to a heatwave being officially declared in some parts of the UK. Time to dig out the sun cream again!

WEATHER · UK
- 5

The Home Secretary has admitted that 'fundamental failures' by the government contributed to the recent attack in Southport.

Shabana Mahmood stated the government accepts the findings of an inquiry into the incident. This admission highlights serious concerns about public safety and government accountability.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1 **It's the celebrity wedding of the year! Taylor Swift and Travis Kelce are reportedly celebrating their nuptials with a huge party in New York this weekend.**

After months of speculation, the couple are said to be marking their big day at Madison Square Garden. Stars like Graham Norton and Phoebe Waller-Bridge have already been spotted arriving in the city.

ON AIR – Are you a 'Swelce' fan? What's your favourite Taylor Swift song to dance to?

CELEBRITY · THIS WEEKEND

2 **Madonna's highly anticipated 15th album, 'Confessions II', has finally dropped after a 21-year wait!**

The Queen of Pop's new record promises to start on the dancefloor before delving into deep personal revelations. Fans have been eagerly awaiting this follow-up for over two decades.

ON AIR – Are you excited for new Madonna music? What's your all-time favourite Madonna track?

MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

3 **Bulgarian singer Dara, who won Eurovision this year with 'Bangaranga', has revealed she almost quit the competition twice!**

Despite her historic victory in Vienna, Dara admitted her journey to the top was almost derailed by doubts. It just goes to show what perseverance can achieve!

ON AIR – What was your favourite Eurovision moment from this year?

MUSIC · EUROVISION

4 **Tens of thousands of people are rushing to get tickets for a truly historic event: the Bayeux Tapestry is coming to the UK!**

This will be the first time the iconic masterpiece has travelled from France to be displayed on British soil. It's an incredible opportunity to see a piece of living history.

ON AIR – Would you queue up to see the Bayeux Tapestry? What historical artefact would you love to see in person?

ART · COMING UP

5 **A new plaque has been unveiled in honour of actors Timothy West and Prunella Scales, celebrating their TV show 'Great Canal Journeys' as a 'love story'.**

Their son, Samuel West, unveiled the plaque, reflecting on the enduring appeal of the series. It was a beautiful tribute to a much-loved couple and their adventures.

ON AIR – Do you have a favourite TV show that feels like a 'love story'?

TV · TRIBUTE

On the schedule

1 **England have fought back to beat DR Congo in a tense World Cup encounter, with Harry Kane scoring twice to secure their place in the last 16!**

The dramatic win in Atlanta sets up a highly anticipated last-16 meeting with Mexico. Fans will be buzzing after that comeback!

ON AIR – How are you feeling about England's chances now? Can they go all the way?

FOOTBALL · WORLD CUP

2 **British hopes are still alive at Wimbledon! Arthur Fery has battled back from a set down to reach the third round.**

It was a fantastic fightback from Fery, but unfortunately, Katie Swan is out of the women's singles. All eyes will be on Fery now!

ON AIR – Who are you backing at Wimbledon this year? Any dark horses you're keeping an eye on?

TENNIS · WIMBLEDON

3 **George Furbank is set to make his first England start in nearly two years this Saturday against South Africa in the Nations Championship.**

This will be a big moment for Furbank as England kick off their summer series in Johannesburg. It's great to see new faces get a chance!

ON AIR – Are you looking forward to the rugby this weekend? What are your predictions for the England vs South Africa game?

RUGBY · UK

4 **Good news for England fans! The government may now allow pubs to extend their opening hours for the 1am England vs Mexico World Cup clash.**

Initially, the government had said it wouldn't relax licensing laws further for the tournament. This change of heart will be welcomed by many who want to watch the big game!

ON AIR – Will you be staying up late to watch England vs Mexico? What's your favourite spot to watch big matches?

FOOTBALL · WORLD CUP

5 **Tottenham have shattered their club record fee, signing Mateus Fernandes from West Ham for an incredible £85 million!**

This huge transfer shows Spurs are serious about strengthening their squad. It's a massive statement of intent from the North London club.

ON AIR – What do you make of these huge transfer fees in football? Is any player worth £85 million?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A surge in popularity for 'vintage board games' is bringing families closer together for screen-free fun.**
Families are rediscovering classic board games like 'Cluedo' and 'Monopoly', finding joy in face-to-face interaction and a break from digital entertainment.
- 2 Research suggests that 'the colour yellow' can actually boost your mood and creativity.**
Studies indicate that exposure to yellow hues can stimulate feelings of happiness and optimism, making it a great colour to incorporate into your home or wardrobe.
- 3 The simple pleasure of 'writing a letter' is making a charming comeback, connecting people in a more personal way.**
Many are choosing to put pen to paper, enjoying the thoughtful process of crafting a letter and the delight of receiving a handwritten message in return.
- 4 A new trend sees people embracing 'themed dinner parties' with elaborate menus and decorations.**
From a '1920s Gatsby' night to a 'tropical luau', hosts are getting creative, turning a simple meal into an immersive experience for guests.
- 5 The humble 'bird feeder' is being credited with bringing more wildlife and joy to urban gardens.**
Watching colourful birds flock to a feeder offers a peaceful connection to nature and a chance to observe local wildlife right outside your window.
- 6 Experts are encouraging us to 'reconnect with our inner child' through playful activities.**
Activities like skipping stones, blowing bubbles, or building a sandcastle can reduce stress and bring a sense of light-hearted fun back into adult lives.
- 7 The art of 'jam making' is seeing a revival, with many enjoying the satisfaction of homemade preserves.**
From strawberry to plum, people are turning surplus fruit into delicious jams and marmalades, perfect for breakfast or as a thoughtful gift.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our shoes when we come in after a long day, even if we know we shouldn't?

ANSWER: KICKING THEM OFF AS SOON AS WE'RE THROUGH THE DOOR!

Q Our survey said that over 50% of us admit to having a particular 'mug' that only we are allowed to use for our tea or coffee. What's special about it?

ANSWER: IT'S THE PERFECT SIZE, SHAPE, AND KEEPS THE DRINK WARM JUST RIGHT!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you try a 'new hot drink' that isn't tea or coffee, and it becomes your new favourite?

What's that unexpected drink you've discovered and now can't get enough of? Maybe it's a specific herbal infusion, a fancy hot chocolate, or something else entirely!

- We all have those little 'comfort items' that we keep around the house – not necessarily valuable, but they hold a lot of sentimental worth, don't we?

What's that one item in your home that might seem ordinary to others, but means the world to you? Is it an old photo, a souvenir, or a well-loved blanket?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is officially called a 'business'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Ostriches can bury their heads in the sand to hide from predators, a trick they use surprisingly often.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.93 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.93 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'I am'.
- A cloud can weigh more than a million pounds, despite looking light and airy.
- The Great Wall of China is not visible from space with the naked eye, despite popular myth.
- Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.
- The inventor of the Pringle can, Fredric Baur, had his ashes buried in one.
- The Eiffel Tower can be 15 cm taller during the summer due to the expansion of the iron in the heat.
- Dragonflies have six legs, but they cannot walk.

On this day

Day 184 of the year, 181 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anatolius of Constantinople; Christian feast day: Anatolius of Laodicea; Christian feast day: Dathus; Christian feast day: Germanus of Man. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1938 — Rhoda Scott, American soul and jazz Hammond organist
- 1949 — Susan Penhaligon, English actress
- 1940 — Michael Cole, American actor (died 2024)
- 1958 — Siân Lloyd, Welsh meteorologist and journalist
- 1952 — Carla Olson, American singer-songwriter and music producer
- 1980 — Olivia Munn, American actress and television host
- 1956 — Montel Williams, American talk show host and television personality
- 1946 — Johnny Lee, American singer and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1973 — David Bowie retires his stage persona Ziggy Stardust with the surprise announcement that it is "the last show that we'll ever do" on the last day of the Ziggy Stardust Tour.
- 1886 — Karl Benz officially unveils the Benz Patent-Motorwagen, the first purpose-built automobile.
- 1952 — The Constitution of Puerto Rico is approved by the United States Congress.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1952 — The SS United States sets sail on her maiden voyage to Southampton. During the voyage, the ship takes the Blue Riband away from the RMS Queen Mary.
- 1938 — World speed record for a steam locomotive is set in England, by the Mallard, which reaches a speed of 125.88 miles per hour (202.58 km/h).

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2006 — The Valencia Metro derailment kills 41 people.
- 1898 — A Spanish squadron, led by Pascual Cervera y Topete, is defeated by an American squadron under William T. Sampson in the Battle of Santiago de Cuba.

- 1913 — Confederate veterans at the Great Reunion of 1913 reenact Pickett's Charge; upon reaching the high-water mark of the Confederacy they are met by the outstretched hands of friendship from Union survivors.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 185 of the year, 180 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Antoine Daniel; Christian feast day: Andrew of Crete; Christian feast day: Bertha of Artois; Christian feast day: Blessed Catherine Jarrige. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1931 — Stephen Boyd, Northern Ireland-born American actor (died 1977)
- 1924 — Eva Marie Saint, American actress
- 1950 — David Jensen, Canadian-English radio and television host
- 1952 — John Waite, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1952 — Carol MacReady, English actress
- 1938 — Bill Withers, American singer-songwriter and producer (died 2020)
- 1966 — Ronni Ancona, Scottish actress and screenwriter
- 1943 — Alan Wilson, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 1970)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1961 — On its maiden voyage, the Soviet nuclear-powered submarine K-19 suffers a complete loss of coolant to its reactor. The crew are able to effect repairs, but 22 of them die of radiation poisoning over the following two years.
- 1976 — Israeli commandos raid Entebbe airport in Uganda, rescuing all but four of the passengers and crew of an Air France jetliner seized by Palestinian terrorists.
- 2001 — Vladivostok Air Flight 352 crashes on approach to Irkutsk Airport killing all 145 people on board.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1054 — A supernova, called SN 1054, is seen by Chinese Song dynasty, Arab, and possibly Amerindian observers near the star Zeta Tauri. For several months it remains bright enough to be seen during the day. Its remnants form the Crab Nebula.
- 2025 — The Oasis Live '25 tour began in Principality Stadium, Cardiff, ending a 16 year hiatus.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)